

Combo Scheduler: Quick Start

The Combo Scheduler makes the combo show calendar from the sign-up and conflict forms, and helps with swaps during the semester. Everything happens in one window: you click buttons, you never type commands.

First time on a computer (once)

- 1 **Windows:** unzip **Combo Scheduler** anywhere (e.g. Documents; not in the data folder) and double-click **Combo Scheduler.exe**. If Windows says "Windows protected your PC", click **More info**, then **Run anyway** (once). **Mac:** open the program folder and double-click *Make Schedule.command* (if it can't be opened: **System Settings > Privacy & Security > Open Anyway**; the first time, click **Install** and wait a minute).
- 2 The scheduler asks for its **data folder** (it holds everything): **Choose existing folder** (e.g. the shared *Combo Scheduler data* in OneDrive), or **Make a new folder**. From now on, opening the program is all you need.

While combos sign up

- Each new combo sends you an **approval email in Outlook**. Click **Accept**, **Accept - first-year combo** or **Reject**. That's it.
- **Combos** tab: right-click a combo or a person (or use **Actions**) to add or remove a member, change the liaison, fix a name, email or conflict, or withdraw a combo. Changes are saved when you click **Confirm changes** (the bar under the list).

Making the schedule (once, after sign-ups close)

- 1 **Settings** tab: check the semester name (exactly as on the form, e.g. *Winter 2027*), the first and last show day, and the skip dates (reading week, holidays). Click **Save settings**. If it asks about moving last semester's files, click **Yes**.
- 2 **Run** tab, **Step 1: Check**. Read any orange or red lines: they say what to look at.
- 3 **Step 2: Make schedule**. Wait up to a minute or two.
- 4 **Schedule** tab: **Export PDF** (the calendar) or **Export Excel** (one table per night). **Combos** tab: **Export PDF** or **Export Excel** (the combo list). Print or send them.

During the semester

- **A combo can't make a show:** **Swaps** tab, pick the combo and the show, pick an option, click **Add to pending changes**, then **Confirm changes**. **Copy swap summary** and **Copy liaison emails** give you an email ready to send. The PDF and Excel files update themselves.
- **Emails for a night:** **Schedule** tab, right-click the night, **Copy combo emails** (or the liaisons'), then paste into Outlook.
- **Don't click Step 2 again** once the schedule is out: it makes a brand-new schedule. **Step 3: Check** is always safe.

If something goes wrong

- Red text in the Run tab says what's wrong: read it first. *Something went wrong:* **About > Open the log** and email that file to the person in the **About** tab.
- **Backup...** (top right) now and then: the whole data folder as one zip. Keep it off this computer. **Restore...** puts a backup into a new folder; nothing is overwritten.
- **New computer?** Do the first-time steps again, then choose the same data folder, or restore a backup. Use one computer at a time (the app says if it is open elsewhere).